

STAGE FOURTEEN • PROJECT MANAGEMENT

FIRSTS

SESSION DEBRIEF / CLOSE-OUT SCRIPT

How to end each session, summarize, and bridge to what's next

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

BY AYOMIDE AYENI

FIRSTS • Session Debrief / Close-Out Script

Stage Fourteen • Project Management

WHY THIS MATTERS

A genuine close-out does three things every time: names what was actually accomplished, connects it forward to what's next, and gives a specific, concrete action to take before the next session. Given this stage's procedural density, the close-out also plays a real role in helping participants see the throughline across many individual FIRSTS, rather than experiencing the session as a disconnected checklist of project management terms.

Close-Out Scripts

SESSION 1

Closing Session 1

"Today you built the full foundation of a real project plan: lifecycle awareness, initiation, scope, requirements, deliverables, timeline, work breakdown, resources, risk, and dependencies."

"Notice how much of today was about making things explicit that are often left implicit — scope, requirements, risk. That explicitness is most of what separates deliberate project management from just winging it."

"Before next time: bring your planning documents from today. Next session, your project actually starts moving."

SESSION 2

Closing Session 2

"Today moved from planning to genuine execution: mapping stakeholders, planning communication, reporting status, verifying milestones, managing change, tracking issues, mitigating risk, budgeting, updating your schedule honestly, and consolidating everything into one tool."

"The common thread today was honesty under pressure — an honest schedule, an honest budget, an honestly verified milestone. That discipline is what keeps a project genuinely under control, not just appearing to be."

"Before next time: think about whether you've ever worked on an Agile, Scrum, or Kanban team, even informally."

SESSION 3

Closing Session 3 (Stage Close)

"That's Stage Fourteen, complete. We've covered planning, execution, modern methodologies, and formal closure — the full lifecycle from R1 all the way through."

"FIRST R30 asked you to commit to managing one real project end-to-end. That commitment is the actual point of this entire stage — not any single FIRST in isolation, but genuinely applying the full lifecycle to something real."

"Before we close: name the specific project you're committing to manage end-to-end, out loud or in the shared doc."

"Stage Fifteen picks up with Business & Organizational Acumen — understanding the broader organizational context that every project you manage actually sits inside."